

Minutes for the Cincinnati Contradance Meeting of April 9, 2007

Attending the meeting: Christie Brock, Chuck Reidmiller, Jim Good, Eileen Bens, Debra Lucas, Karen E. Keeton, Colette Palmer, Paul Fox, Mary Jane Miller, Pam Stoll, Susan V. Vogt, John McCain, Jim Vogt, Darlene Underwood, Bernadene Zennie, Larry Lankford.

Minutes from the 02-19-07 meeting were read and approved.

Pigtown: A partial refund was requested for a dancer who had pre-registered and was not able to attend the Friday dance. It was approved to be the difference between what was paid initially and what the attended items would have cost individually. It is customary to provide refunds when asked, but could change if it becomes a problem for the community. Jim Good noted that Sandy and Orlan Jennings, who did pre-registration the past few years, are moving. Jim, having done this job before, volunteered to handle the pre-registration next year. A Pigtown debriefing meeting will be held at Paul's house Apr 22 at 3PM. [Meeting changed to April 30 at 6:30 before the dance]

Announcements at dances: Announcements are not being heard due to noise and other distractions. Discussion concluded that we will experiment with the caller making all announcements since the caller already has the dancers' attention and the sound system is set for the caller's voice. This will take less time than having many people make individual announcements. Cards will be provided for people to fill out and hand to the caller. The caller will promote the use of the cards prior to announcement time. Making announcements before the waltz or after the break supplemented with a monthly e-mail to reinforce announcements was also suggested. We may experiment with this also but no definitive decision was made.

Kentucky Folklife Festival Report from Darlene:

- The Kentucky Folklife Festival is an ongoing event. This year contradancing will be added. Event dates are Sept 21-23, the venue is downtown Frankfort. Airdance is the featured band, playing Friday night, Saturday night, and Sunday. Kathy Anderson will call the Friday night dance, Darlene will call Saturday and Sunday. Darlene will try to organize a family dance for Saturday afternoon.
- The Lexington group is responsible for the Saturday events.
- A grant may help pay for the dance events. David Atcher (Lexington) has agreed to underwrite the band if funding does not come through.
- The coalition of dance groups from Lexington, Louisville and Berea has asked that one or two people from the Cincinnati dance group join the festival board, attend meetings and give community input.

Several topics were brought up during the discussion:

- Possibilities of providing and distributing promotional material to dancers
- Timing problems due to distance to provide logistical support on Friday
- We should encourage dancers to attend, while also promoting Dayton's first day-long dance endeavor occurring on Sept 22

No-one volunteered to represent Cincinnati on the festival board, but Paul agreed to contact Clint Cummins (Louisville) and see what the Cincinnati group might do to help.

The Mason dance was discussed and it was determined that the Cincinnati group would not take on the responsibility, but would make announcements to facilitate interested individuals to form a dance community to continue the Mason dances. It was noted that attendance has been small, and although the Grange Hall is an attractive dance venue, the hall is small and could not accommodate a large number of dancers, and is not a very central location.

Respectfully submitted by Larry Lankford, secretary